

FOOD BRIDGE:Where extra food finds its way home

A lot of small restaurants, bakeries and even some households end up throwing away food that's still good to eat, just because it didn't get sold or used in time. Meanwhile there are families in the area who don't always have enough to eat. The food isn't the problem but it is that there is no fast and organized way of connecting people who have extra food to those who need it before it becomes wasted.

This affects food insecure families because they would miss out on food that is perfectly good to eat due to businesses and households that waste money and food since the food just rots in landfills that produce methane gas. Right now donations happen through group chats or word of mouth which is really slow and easy to miss out on for those who don't have the resources to find these donations, so the system needs a way to reach people who don't have devices. This is worth solving because it's a real and local problem that a simple system could help with.

OBJECTIVES OF THE PROJECT

1. Design a system that would connect a food listing to the nearest available receiver or a partner drop off point within 10 minutes of being posted.
2. Reduce number of manual coordination steps needed to complete a food donation from 6 steps into just 2 steps that would be posting a listing and confirming a match.
3. Ensure the system is usable by at least two types of recipients namely those that have access with a phone and those without one by routing non phone users through partner drop off point instead of them missing out.

FEATURES

● POST A LISTING

-Donors can list surplus food with type, amount and pickup window

● AUTOMATIC MATCHING

-System checks new listings against registered recipients based on location and type of food

● PARTNER DROP OFF POINT

-for recipients without a phone or app access, food gets routed to a nearby partner site that handles in person distribution

● MATCH NOTIFICATIONS

-matched recipients get alerted to confirm pickup

- **STATUS TRACKING**

-listings move from posted to matched to picked up or to expired if nobody claims in time

INPUT

- Donor info
- Recipient info
- Partner site
- user actions
- system checking

OUTPUT

- List of nearby
- Notification sent
- updated status of listing
- expired listings